

Sumit Sahay

PHARMACEUTICAL MICROBIOLOGY • QA / QMS • VALIDATION & QUALIFICATION

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— PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Accomplished pharmaceutical **Microbiology & Quality** professional with **14+ years** of experience across Quality Control and Quality Assurance in sterile and non-sterile manufacturing. Proven leader of teams of up to **35 members**, driving **GMP/cGMP compliance, validation & qualification (IQ/OQ/PQ)**, and robust **Quality Management Systems (QMS)**. Deep expertise in deviation management, **OOS/OOT investigations, CAPA**, root cause analysis, **data integrity (ALCOA+)**, and **US FDA audit readiness**. Skilled in contamination control strategy, environmental monitoring, sterility assurance, and rapid microbiological methods.

— CORE COMPETENCIES

cGMP / GLP / GDP

Quality Management System (QMS)

Validation & Qualification (IQ/OQ/PQ)

Process & Method Validation

Deviation Management

OOS / OOT Investigations

CAPA

Change Control

Root Cause Analysis (RCA)

Data Integrity (ALCOA+)

21 CFR Part 11

US FDA / WHO-GMP Audits

Contamination Control Strategy (CCS)

Environmental Monitoring (EM)

Sterility Assurance

Aseptic Processing

SOP / STP Authoring

Team Leadership & Mentoring

— TECHNICAL & LABORATORY SKILLS

Microbiological Testing: Microbial Limit Tests (MLT), Sterility Testing, Bacterial Endotoxin Testing (BET/LAL)

Validation Studies: Media Fill, Growth Promotion, Hold Time, Decimal Reduction Time (DRT), Autoclave Requalification

Monitoring: Environmental Monitoring, Water Analysis, Liquid/Airborne Particle Count (21 CFR)

Identification: Microbial Identification, Biological Indicators, Spore Count Studies

QMS Software: TrackWise (Deviation / OOS / CAPA / Change Control)

Instrumentation: pH Meter, Conductivity Meter, Balance — Calibration & Qualification

Documentation: SOPs, STPs, Specifications, COAs, Validation Protocols & Reports

Methods: Rapid Microbiological Methods (RMM), Aseptic Technique, Cleanroom Operations

— PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Deputy Manager — Quality, Corporate Microbiology
Otsuka Pharmaceutical Pvt. Ltd. — Ahmedabad, India

Jan 2025 – Present

- Lead a **23-member team**, planning routine operations and ensuring smooth, on-time execution.
- Develop and oversee **validation plans** for instruments and equipment across corporate sites.
- Manage deviations, **OOS/OOT** events, investigations and **CAPA** in line with QMS requirements.
- Drive implementation of **rapid microbiological methods** to improve testing efficiency.
- Design and deliver corporate microbiology and **GMP compliance training programs**; mentor site microbiologists and lab managers.
- Spearhead the **Contamination Control Strategy (CCS)** and champion a strong **data integrity** culture.
- Analyze corporate metrics — OOS trends, **environmental monitoring (EM)** trends and water quality trends — with root cause analysis.
- Lead **IQ/OQ/PQ**, process validation, media fill studies, **BET**, sterility validation and hold time studies.
- Ensure full **audit readiness** for internal and external inspections; author and update SOPs/STPs to current regulatory guidelines.

Assistant Manager — Quality Control Microbiology

May 2022 – Jan 2025

Zyklus Lifesciences Ltd. — Ahmedabad, India

- Developed plans and schedules for validation of equipment, instruments and methods.
- Managed deviations, OOS/OOT events, investigations and CAPA within **TrackWise QMS** software.
- Provided decision-making support for routine activities and validation processes.
- Reviewed testing of raw materials, finished products, stability and in-process samples using **Microbial Limit Tests (MLT)**.
- Assigned tasks, supervised lab activities, reviewed results and implemented CAPA against internal audit responses.

Assistant Manager — Quality Control Microbiology

Sep 2021 – Mar 2022

Akums Drugs & Pharmaceuticals — Haridwar, India

- Supervised a **35-member team** across sterility, BET, MLT, media preparation and validation execution.
- Executed method validation and instrument qualification (pH meters, conductivity meters).
- Managed **IQ/OQ/PQ** for microbiology equipment and instruments, maintaining documentation with vendor records.
- Handled deviations, OOS/OOT events, investigations and CAPA; made critical decisions on routine and validation work.
- Reviewed MLT testing of raw materials, finished products, stability and in-process samples; ensured internal audit compliance.

Senior Executive — Quality Control Microbiology

May 2018 – Sep 2021

IPCA Laboratories Ltd. — Silvassa & Vadodara, India

- Led a **20-member team**, managing work assignments and daily laboratory operations.
- Managed **IQ/OQ/PQ** for microbiology equipment and instruments with complete documentation.
- Addressed deviations, OOS/OOT events, investigations and CAPA.
- Reviewed testing of raw materials, finished products and stability samples; performed MLT on stability and in-process samples.
- Ensured internal audit compliance (major/minor points) and managed **US FDA audit responses**.

Officer — Quality Control Microbiology

Sep 2015 – Feb 2018

Oman Pharmaceutical Products Co. LLC — Salalah, Oman

- Authored and reviewed SOPs, specifications, test procedures, **COAs** and validation protocols; prepared reports for MLT and **Decimal Reduction Time (DRT)** studies.
- Managed deviations, OOS/OOT events, investigations and CAPA; developed validation plans and schedules.
- Conducted MLT and chemical & microbiological water analysis; managed instrument calibration and equipment qualification.

Quality Control Officer-II, Microbiologist

Jun 2014 – Jun 2015

Sun Pharmaceuticals Ltd. — Halol, India

- Tested raw materials, finished products, stability and in-process samples using MLT, BET, particle count and water analysis.
- Conducted BET/MLT validation, spore count studies, growth promotion tests, autoclave requalification and environmental monitoring; performed microbial identification and biological indicator handling.
- Performed liquid-borne particle count analysis in compliance with **21 CFR** particulate matter testing.

Quality Control Officer, Microbiologist

Feb 2012 – May 2014

Cipla Pharmaceuticals Ltd. — Verna, India

- Tested raw materials, finished products, stability and in-process samples using MLT, BET and water analysis.
- Managed environmental monitoring, media fills and investigations; performed MLT, water and BET validation.
- Prepared media, sterilization and growth promotion tests; participated in internal audits to strengthen **cGMP**.

— EDUCATION

M.Sc., Microbiology — Bangalore University, Bangalore

2008 – 2010 · 67%

B.Sc., Microbiology & Chemistry — Goa University, Goa

2005 – 2008 · 65%